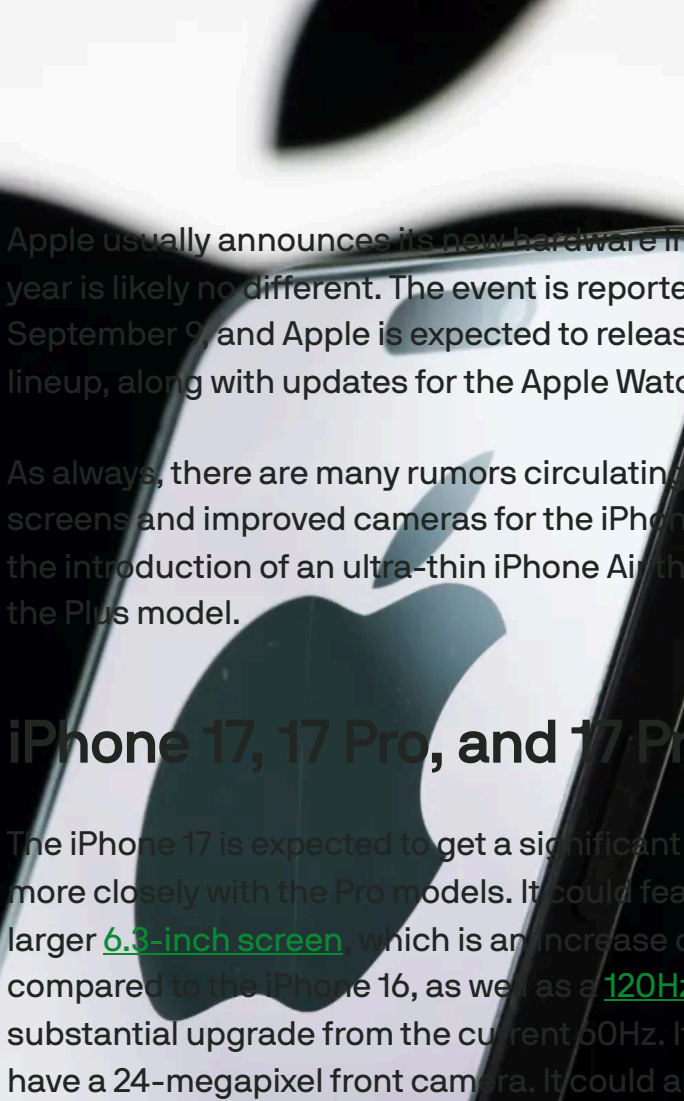

HARDWARE



iPhone 17, the ‘thinnest iPhone ever,’ and everything else we’re expecting out of Apple’s hardware event



Apple usually announces its new hardware in the fall, and this year is likely no different. The event is reported to be on September 9, and Apple is expected to release its iPhone 17 lineup, along with updates for the Apple Watch and AirPods.

As always, there are many rumors circulating, including bigger screens and improved cameras for the iPhone 17 models and the introduction of an ultra-thin iPhone Air that could replace the Plus model.

iPhone 17, 17 Pro, and 17 Pro Max

The iPhone 17 is expected to get a significant makeover to align more closely with the Pro models. It could feature a slightly larger [6.3-inch screen](#), which is an increase of 0.2 inches compared to the iPhone 16, as well as a [120Hz display](#), a substantial upgrade from the current 60Hz. It's also rumored to have a 24-megapixel front camera. It could also come in new colors: purple and green.

PHOTO CREDITS: CHENG XIN / GETTY IMAGES

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The Pro's upgrades will be noticeable on the back of the phone, rumors suggest. [Conceptual renderings](#) show that the three rear cameras may be arranged in a rectangular bar that extends from one edge of the device to the other. The flash, light sensor, and microphone would be positioned far to the right side. Where the MagSafe charger is, the Apple logo is said to be centered for aesthetic reasons.

Notably, the iPhone 17 Pro may switch materials, potentially replacing the titanium band around the screen with aluminum. This could help Apple reduce costs as well as provide a lighter feel.

The iPhone 17 Pro Max is expected to see fewer upgrades, too, with the most significant change being a slightly thicker body, likely to accommodate a larger battery — which would be a huge win.

According to [leaker Instant Digital](#), the iPhone 17 is predicted to be priced around \$800, and the Pro Max is expected to have a

price tag of \$1,250. New colors for the Pro models potentially include [dark blue and copper](#).



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The Pro model is expected to be priced around \$1,050. However, a [recent leak](#) indicates that there will be fewer storage options compared to the 16 Pro. Users may lose the 128GB option and will only have three choices: 256GB, 512GB, or 1TB, down from the typical four options.

iPhone Air



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE TRACK

The most widely discussed rumor is that Apple might be introducing its slimmest phone ever, [the iPhone Air](#), which may replace the iPhone Plus.

This rumored device is said to have a profile thickness of 5.5 mm, making it about 0.08 inches thinner than current iPhones.

It'll also feature a 6.6-inch screen.

This move appears to be Apple's response to the trend of slimmer smartphones, following in the footsteps of other companies like Samsung and Huawei. The iPhone Air could potentially outshine the Samsung Galaxy S25 Edge, which measures 5.8 mm thick. Additionally, it may pave the way for [Apple's long-rumored foldable phone](#), predicted to launch in September 2026.

While the thin design is stylish, it would come with some compromises. Based on the [renders](#) we've seen, the Air is expected to have only one rear camera lens, unlike the Plus, which has two. There are also [rumors](#) that there may not be enough space for a speaker at the bottom, meaning the only audio source could be the front earpiece at the top.

Reports suggest the device will be priced at \$950 and will be available in black, silver, and light gold.

Apple Watch Series 11, Ultra 3, and SE 3



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

After a two-year wait, there are various rumors surrounding the Apple Watch Ultra 3, suggesting it will undergo significant changes. These may include faster charging speeds, 5G support, and satellite connectivity. Additionally, it's speculated that the watch will feature a [larger display](#).

One of the most exciting potential upgrades for both the Ultra 3 and Series 11 is the incorporation of blood pressure monitoring capabilities. This feature would notify users if their blood

pressure levels are too high or too low. Apple is also considering adding a sleep apnea feature. However, according to Bloomberg's Mark Gurman, the company [may need to delay the release of these features for further tweaks](#).

Apple recently announced that a [redesigned blood oxygen feature](#) is rolling out to some Series 8, 10, and Ultra watches. This leads us to think the Ultra 3 may also get the capability, but the company didn't mention if it would be available in the watchOS 26 in its announcement.

The third generation of Apple Watch SE isn't expected to receive major updates, aside from possibly a larger display. There continue to be reports of a plastic version being introduced, according to Gurman.

Rumored prices for the watches are: \$250 for the Apple Watch SE 3, \$400 for the Series 11, and \$800 for the Ultra 3.

AirPods Pro 3



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

After the release of the AirPods Pro 2 in 2022, it's about time for an upgrade, and Apple might just be ready to deliver. [Rumors](#) suggest that the AirPods Pro 3 will feature a sleeker design, touch-sensitive controls, smaller earbuds, and a slimmer case. Additionally, the H3 chip is expected to enhance active noise cancellation and adaptive audio.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

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Pixel 10, AI capabilities, and everything else we expect out of the Made by Google 2025 event

Lauren Forristal — 9:30 AM PDT · August 18, 2025



As anticipation builds for the [Made by Google 2025 event](#), there's a buzz around the Pixel 10 series, arriving notably before the [iPhone 17](#). Apple's [hardware event](#) is expected to take place in September.

The tech giant has made its intentions clear to grow the Pixel line, likely incorporating more generative AI capabilities with Gemini. Made by Google starts at 10 a.m. PT on Wednesday.

Get ready for a Gemini boost

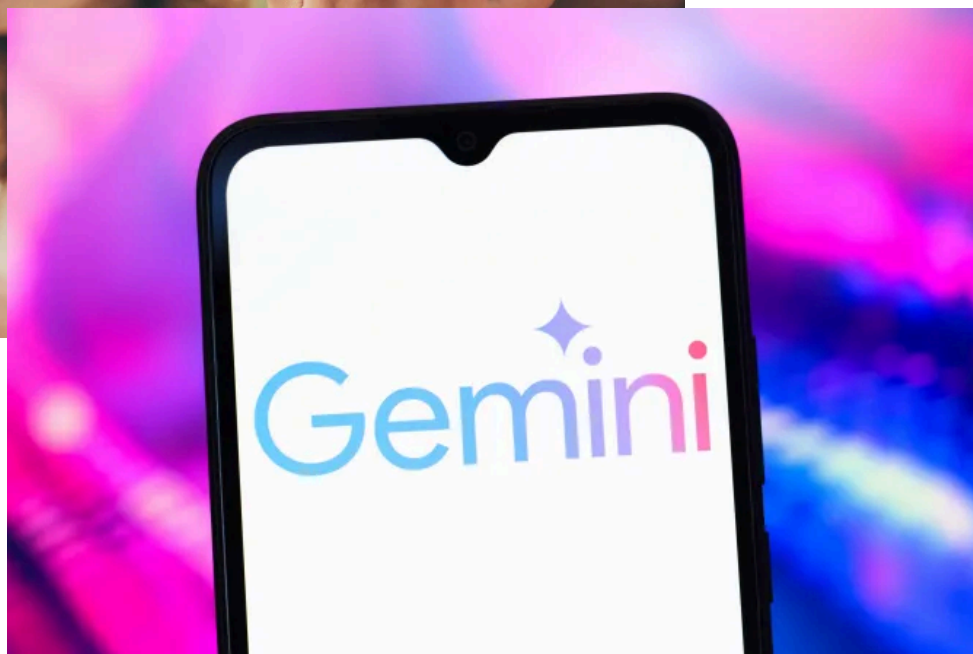


IMAGE CREDITS: THOMAS FULLER/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Google already dropped several AI-related updates at its [developer conference](#) in May, but the company will likely demonstrate more Gemini features during the Pixel 10 event. In a recent [YouTube video](#) promoting the new devices, Google even seemed to poke fun at Apple's failed promises with Apple Intelligence advancements on the iPhone.

[Rumors](#) are buzzing about a feature called "Camera Coach," which would let Gemini give you real-time tips for taking better photos. The AI is supposedly able to see what's going on and suggest the best angles and lighting for your shot.

There's also talk of a [conversational photo editing tool](#), where you tell Gemini what you want to tweak in a photo, such as

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Google Pixel 10 | Soon



Pixel 10, 10 Pro, and 10 Pro XL

The standard Pixel 10 phone is expected to undergo significant changes, particularly with the addition of a dedicated telephoto lens, a feature that was previously exclusive to the Pro models. Following the leak of renders showcasing the third rear lens, [Google released a teaser for the Pixel 10](#), confirming the substantial camera upgrade.

Additionally, all phones in the lineup are expected to be powered by a new Tensor G5 processor, ushering in the Gemini era and enhancing performance and power efficiency compared to the Tensor G4 chip.



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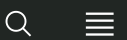


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Aside from these updates, not many obvious changes appear to be on the table. The basic design of the phones will likely remain similar to that of the Pixel 9 series. The displays are also expected to stay the same, with the Pixel 10 and Pixel 10 Pro featuring a 6.3-inch display, and the Pixel 10 Pro XL with a larger 6.8-inch display.

Some areas where the Pro models may see improvement are camera and video quality, along with battery size, which could

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alongside an 8-inch main screen. Additionally, Google is reportedly enhancing the strength of the hinge, and the bezels are expected to be thinner for a sleek appearance.

Another exciting rumor is the possibility of an [IP68 rating](#), a first for the device. (And according to leaked specs, [this may in fact be coming](#).) This means it can stand up to both dust and water, whereas the Pixel 9 Pro Fold has zero dust protection.

... pic.twitter.com/iJdzbRaDgK

Like the other Pixel 10 phones, the Pro Fold will likely be powered by the new G5 chip and include the latest Gemini AI features. The camera system might also receive improvements, potentially featuring a 48-megapixel ultra-wide lens and a telephoto lens with 5x optical zoom. The phone should also likely get a bump in battery life.

The Pixel 10 may come in Moonstone and Jade colors.

The Pixel Watch and Pixel Buds

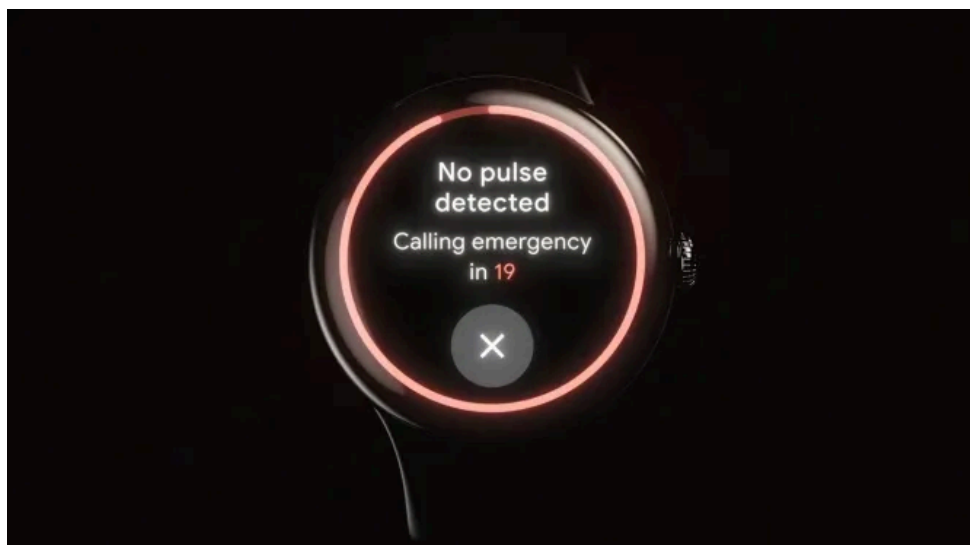


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Wearables will also get their time to shine at Google's event, with the Pixel Watch 4 rumored to get a thicker design, a longer battery life, and smaller bezels.

There's also a strong likelihood that the smartwatch will introduce new health and fitness-tracking capabilities, possibly including an upgraded [blood oxygen \(SpO2\) monitoring](#) function.

[Leaks](#) of the Pixel Buds 2a indicate that the earbuds will come in new colors (Fog Light, Hazel, Iris, and Strawberry) along with [features](#) like active noise cancellation. The Pixel Buds Pro 2 will also reportedly come in a new Sterling color.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

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IMAGE CREDITS: PARADIGM

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Why Paradigm built a spreadsheet with an AI agent in every cell

Rebecca Szkutak — 8:00 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Anna Monaco has been building AI agents since before the term “AI agents” was even a thing. After building numerous chatbots,

she started looking for other types of interfaces that made sense for AI agents and landed on spreadsheets.

“I had this personal pattern, and I noticed that a lot of other people had this pattern, of putting very important CRM data in spreadsheets just because it was the most flexible thing,” Monaco told TechCrunch. “But it was actually a pain to maintain. There’s so much manual work involved. So [I] just went down this rabbit hole of building a product for myself and wanted to reimagine what a spreadsheet could look like with the full power of LLMs.”

The result was [Paradigm](#), an AI-powered spreadsheet equipped with more than 5,000 AI agents. Users can assign different prompts to individual columns and cells, and individual AI agents will crawl the internet to find and fill out the needed information.

Paradigm works with AI models from Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google’s Gemini, Monaco said, and supports model switching.

“We want to support every single model because we want our users to be able to have the highest reasoning outputs when they need it, but also the cheapest outputs,” Monaco said. “It’s just a constant cycle of evaluating different models, working closely with model providers to make sure our limits are high enough, and then giving some of that power to our users.”

The company launched a small closed beta preview in late 2024 and has been iterating on the product using customer feedback. Paradigm attracts users ranging from consultants to sales professionals and finance folks and operates on a subscription model with tiers based on usage. Paradigm counts the consulting firm EY, AI chip startup Etched, and AI coding company Cognition as early customers.

Paradigm is now releasing its product to the public and announcing that it raised a \$5 million seed round led by General Catalyst. The company has raised \$7 million to date. Monaco said the funding will go toward executing on the company’s “extremely aggressive product roadmap.”

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“The interesting thing that happened when we fundraised is some people we pitched just kept on using and paying for the product,” Monaco said. “I think that was a cool part of it. We found a lot of value from it internally and our investors, not even just our investors — other investors that we talked to — are still using it.”

Paradigm isn't the only company looking to give spreadsheets an AI upgrade. [Quadratic](#), which has raised more than \$6 million in venture funding, is a 3-year-old startup with a similar goal. Legacy companies like Google and Microsoft are also adding AI tools to their spreadsheet applications.

Monaco said that she doesn't really consider the competition because Paradigm doesn't think of itself as an AI-powered spreadsheet. She said she thinks of it as a new AI-powered workflow that happens to be in the familiar form of a spreadsheet but won't necessarily stay that way forever.

“What I'm seeing in the most popular AI products now is this fine balance between present and future,” Monaco said. “How do you build something that is really powerful and generates a lot of value now but also sets you up really well for the future? That's the question that I asked myself a year ago when I was starting the company.”

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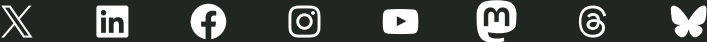
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Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the same beat for Forbes and the...

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